

Email & Outlook Resolution Guide

1. Issue Overview

This document outlines standard operating procedures for resolving Microsoft Outlook connection failures, synchronization errors, and mailbox authentication issues across corporate client devices. Follow these guidelines to troubleshoot recurring issues swiftly and minimize user downtime.

2. Common Scenarios & Fixes

Scenario A Outlook Stuck on "Connecting..." or "Disconnected"

Primary Cause: Password expiration or cached credential conflict in Windows Credential Manager.

Resolution Steps:

1. Close Microsoft Outlook completely and verify no lingering background processes are running via Task Manager.
2. Open Windows Credential Manager by running `control /name Microsoft.CredentialManager` in the Windows Run dialog (Win + R).
3. Under **Windows Credentials**, locate and remove all stored generic or enterprise credentials starting with `MicrosoftOffice16_Data` or related office tokens.
4. Relaunch Outlook and authenticate using your active corporate Azure AD / Microsoft 365 credentials when prompted.

Scenario B Mailbox Storage Exceeded (Quota Limits)

Standard Quota Thresholds:

Storage Level	Threshold	System Impact
Warning Alert	45 GB	User notified via notification banner
Send Blocked	49 GB	Outgoing mail queued in Outbox
Send & Receive Blocked	50 GB	Incoming mail rejected with NDR

Resolution Steps:

1. Empty the **Deleted Items** and **Junk Email** folders entirely to reclaim immediate free space.
2. Run the built-in Mailbox Cleanup utility via **File > Tools > Mailbox Cleanup** to review large items and empty older caches.
3. Enable **AutoArchive** rules to automatically transfer messages older than 6 months to local PST storage or corporate online archive mailboxes.